Sven Struan Finlay

Senior Product Engineer · Taking new products and systems from 0→1

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- **Senior Product Engineer:** Marshmallow (Series C insurtech unicorn): 0→1 delivery lead whose telematics platform now carries £67m+ GWP across 57k policies. Hands on architect of distributed, event driven systems; co-built an internal experimentation platform with Claude in 3 days, now used across 4 functions. Started in health tech with NHS patient risk ML and Medidata clinical trial R&D.
- **Delivery owned end to end:** from writing the PRD and technical design to integrating hardware, logistics and OEM partners whose contracts and APIs are still moving. Leads teams of up to 12 through launch.
- **Deputises for the engineering manager and mentors across the team:** runs delivery syncs, retros and DX reviews in their absence, has mentored four engineers into promotions or new roles, and moved the team onto Claude Code.

Experience

2021 – present — **Senior Product Engineer, Marshmallow (Series C insurtech unicorn), London, UK**

Leads architecture and technical direction for Telematics. First 100 employee; joined as a junior in 2021, promoted May 2022 and March 2026.

- **Product Ownership, 0→1:** Architected and led Marshmallow Move, a usage based insurance product with hardware, from concept to launch in six months. Led a cross functional team of 12, splitting the work into milestones and handing each to an engineer to own, with no signed supplier contract for the first seven weeks. Launched a week early; now **£30m+ GWP** across ~27k policies, **one in five of all new business**.
- **Leadership:** Mentored **2 engineers to promotion**, a frontend engineer into full stack and a data engineer into product engineering; coached two more engineers into leading their own projects.
- **Ownership at Scale:** Reused the platform built for Move as a secondary fraud check for other new customers, now reaching up to **90% of new business** and £36m+ GWP. Led its rearchitecture to saga based event flows through a shadow mode cutover; its data has removed ~£1m of high risk premium.
- **Product Definition:** Writes the PRDs and runs stakeholder refinement end to end, including a licence verification flow now running on **81% of new business**.
- **OEM Integration:** Project lead on Tesla Fleet API, Marshmallow's **first OEM telematics integration** (in build), scoped solo into a 9 milestone, 45 ticket plan the team builds against.
- **Growth and Partnerships:** Led the Optimise affiliate integration (NHS, TopCashback). Spotted overpayments and built the evidence that **recovered £88k** and blocked £161k of invalid claims.

2019 – 2020 — **Project Lead, UCL industry projects with Intel and IBM, London, UK**

Led two agile teams from requirements to delivered proof of concept, reporting to senior stakeholders at both companies.

- **Intel, tech lead:** Sight++, a computer vision navigation aid for visually impaired users
- **IBM:** Drag and drop Watson chatbot builder on Node-RED, letting non technical users build and host conversational AI

2019 — **Innovation Scientist Intern, Medidata Solutions (R&D), London, UK**

Prototyped product concepts with clinical trial experts: on demand 3D printing of surgical tools, and clinical trial workflow optimisation.

Education

2019 – 2020 — **MSc Software Systems Engineering, University College London, UK**

Distinction (First Class, Requirements Engineering and Architecture focus.

2015 – 2019 — **BSc Hons Computer Science, University of St Andrews, UK**

First Class Honours, Dean's Award, HCI and AI focus.

Skills

Java, Spring Boot, TypeScript, React, System & API design, REST, OAuth2, Distributed systems, Event-driven architecture, Sagas, AWS (DynamoDB, Aurora DSQL, SQS, SNS, Kinesis, Firehose, KMS, IAM), Terraform, Docker, Snowflake, SQL, Datadog, TeamCity CI/CD, Third-party/OEM APIs, Incident leadership, Claude Code workflows, A/B testing, PRDs, Milestone planning

Other

- **First author publication:** Sight++: prototyping a computer vision guided assistive technology, Archives of Disease in Childhood (GOSH conference, 2020)
- Built and deployed ML models predicting patient risk for NHS drug and alcohol clinics (St Andrews x NHS, 2018)
- Built features on a microservice mesh in Python, Django and React (Erika Technology, 2021)
- Led the award-winning redesign of The Saint's website and grew the team (SPA Awards UK runner up, 2019)